

ARPIT GAIND

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Profile

Research Domains

- Current project: Indigenous media, digital archives, and visual sovereignty in a comparative framework between settler and post-colonial societies with focus on South Asia and India.
- Fields of interest: media, documentary, and South Asian studies; Indigenous, ethnic, and postcolonial studies; critical geography, counter-mapping, and archival studies; generative AI and society; leadership and project management.

Practice

- Scholarly writing on documentary and Indigenous media, alongside ethnographic filmmaking and film curation.
- Community archive design, including consent-encoded metadata and counter-cartographic mapping.

Teaching

- Media literacy, data justice, and video production, taught as sole instructor and as teaching assistant.
- Pedagogical research on generative AI, writing assessment, and curriculum design.

Skills

- Ethnographic and documentary filmmaking, film curation and programming, community archive design, and metadata schema design in Omeka and WordPress.
- Qualitative and archival research design, oral history method, digital and counter-mapping, data visualization, ATLAS.ti, basic Python, and generative-AI auditing.

Education

Ph.D. Candidate (ABD), Culture and Performance, Department of World Arts and Cultures, UCLA. Expected May 2027.

Dissertation: *Palimpsests of the Ocular: The Negotiated Sovereignty of Adivasi Media and Indigenous Archives in Jharkhand, India.*

Committee: Aparna Sharma (Chair), David Shorter, Anurima Banerji, Michelle Caswell.

Graduate Certificates: Digital Humanities and Writing Pedagogy, UCLA; Oral Histories, UC Berkeley — 2023–2025.

M.Phil., Development Practice — 2015–2018.

Ambedkar University Delhi, School of Human Studies.

M.A., Development Studies — 2012–2014.

Ambedkar University Delhi, Rank 1, School of Development Studies; CGPA 8.75.

B.A., History and Theater, University of Delhi — 2009–2012.

Awards and Honors

External fellowships, awards, and honors

- American Institute of Indian Studies (AIIS) Fellowship (2026–2027), \$7,000.
- Association for Asian Studies Travel Grant, Vancouver (2026), \$500.
- Research Student Award, 28th European Conference on South Asian Studies (2025).
- Emerging Scholar Award, Arts in Society Conference, Zaragoza, Spain (2022).
- Emerging Scholar Award, The Image Conference, Hong Kong (2018).
- Semester Merit Scholarship, School of Development Studies, Ambedkar University Delhi (2012–2014).

UCLA fellowships, awards, and honors

- Collegium of University Teaching Fellows (CUTF) Fellowship, UCLA (2026–2027), \$18,000.
- Charlotte Williams Scholarship (2026–2027), \$8,300.
- Graduate Leadership Academy (Inaugural Cohort), UCLA (2026).
- School of Arts and Architecture Scholarship, UCLA (2024 and 2026), \$3,085; \$2,402.
- Dr. Sambhi Memorial Summer Fellowship, Center for India and South Asia, UCLA (2024 and 2025), \$6,000; \$2,000.
- Elaine Krown Klein Scholarship (2024–2025), \$6,069.
- Graduate Division Merit Award, UCLA (2021–2025), \$30,735 (cumulative).
- Dissertation Fieldwork Fellowship, UCLA International Institute (2023 and 2024), \$2,000; \$1,000.
- Clifton Webb Scholarship of the Arts (2022 and 2024), \$5,000.
- Graduate Summer Research Mentorship (GSRM), UCLA (2023), \$6,000.
- Polly Nooter Roberts Graduate Research Fellowship (2022–2023), \$935.
- Summer Mentorship Research Funding (SMRF), UCLA (2022), \$6,000.

Publications

Book chapters

- “Cameras as Drums, Dance as Maps: Decolonial Visions in Adivasi Media Production in Jharkhand.” In *Reimagining Work, Workers and Workplaces: Decolonial and Intersectional Contestations*, vol. 1, edited by M. Banday, A. Dixit, and M. Amacker. London: Palgrave Macmillan (in press). Invited contribution.
- “Seeing like an Adivasi: Rethinking Representation through Adivasi Media in Jharkhand, India.” Chapter 8 in *A Media Anthropology of India*, edited by P. Raghunath and H. Narasimhan, 126–145. London: Routledge (in press).
- “Politics of Representation: Locating Marginalization of Tribals through Film (making).” In *Understanding Socio-Economic Marginalization and Tribal Issues*, edited by Mohinder Slariya, 163–179. New Delhi: Mittal Publications, 2022.

Peer-reviewed articles

- “Becoming through Film (Making): Politics of Contingency and Re-Presentation.” *Journal of Practical Philosophy* 1, no. 1 (2020): 106–118.

Digital and multimodal publications

- “Adivasi Visual Sovereignty and the Digital Mediascape,” portfolio exhibit (2022).
- With Michelle Caswell. “What is Community Archive,” podcast conversation and media essay (2022).
- “Politics of Other(ing): ‘Remembering’ and ‘Forgetting’ the Indigenous.” *Critical Theory and Information Studies*, February 7, 2022.
- “On Becoming Ho: Remembering, Repeating and Working Through.” *NEWSREACH* 18, no. 1 (February 2018): 23–28.
- Module reading lists on Indigeneity, *American Indian Culture and Research Journal*, UCLA: Representation of Indigenous People in Media and Art; Indigenous Cosmos and Science; Indigeneity and Critical History; Indigeneity and Land; Indigeneity, Feminism and Activism; Impact and Response to COVID-19 by American Indian Communities.

Editorial work

- Editor. *Comitatus: A Journal of Medieval and Renaissance Studies*, vol. 57. Los Angeles: CMRS Center for Early Global Studies, UCLA, 2026.
- Associate Editor. *Journal of Practical Philosophy*, special issue on Action Research Methodologies, vol. 1, no. 1, 2020.
- Editorial Assistant. *The Oxford Handbook of Indian Dance*, edited by A. Banerji and P. Purkayastha. Oxford University Press, 2026.
- Editorial Assistant. *Race and Yoga* 8, no. 1 (2024), edited by T. Blu Wakpa.
- Editorial Assistant. *Jugalbandi: BJP before Modi*, by Vinay Sitapati. Penguin India, 2020. Secondary research and data analysis, 2018–2021.

Translation

- Translator. Anurima Banerji, Lona Bhattacharjee, Aishika Chakraborty, Rajkumar Das, and Prarthana Purkayastha. “Dimensions and Dynamics of Sharing Dance in India: A Conversation,” 2021. Hindi to English. DOI: 10.14361/9783839462379-003.

Book reviews

- Review of *The Middle Ages and the Movies*, by Robert Bartlett. *Comitatus: A Journal of Medieval and Renaissance Studies* 55 (2024): 270–272.
- Review of *Chaucer and the Ethics of Time*, by Gillian Adler. *Comitatus: A Journal of Medieval and Renaissance Studies* 54 (2023): 199–200.
- Review of *Imaging Culture: Photography in Mali, West Africa*, by Candace M. Keller. *Journal of Folklore Research Reviews* (June 2023).

Conference Organizing

- 2026 | Conference Chair, Annual Interdisciplinary Graduate Student Conference on South Asia, Center for India and South Asia (CISA), UCLA.
- 2024 and 2025 | Conference Organizer, Annual Interdisciplinary Graduate Student Conference on South Asia, CISA, UCLA.
- 2021 | Conference Organizer, Critical Media Conference of the Americas, marking the centenary of Paulo Freire.
- 2017–2018 | Conference Organizer and Researcher, Conversations with Ramachandra Guha, Ashoka University, in collaboration with Oxford University Press and Penguin Random House.

Conference Presentations

- 2026 | “Palimpsests of the Ocular: Adivasi (Indigenous) Media Sovereignty at the Nexus of Transnational Media Networks in India.” Society for Cinema and Media Studies, Montreal.
- 2026 | “Reclaiming the Ocular: Adivasi Cinema, Global Indigenous Media Sovereignty, and the Struggle for Visual Self-Determination in Jharkhand, India.” 54th Annual Conference on South Asia, University of Wisconsin–Madison, October 2026 (accepted); and Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference, Vancouver.
- 2026 | “Reclaiming the Ocular: Adivasi Cinema and Transnational Indigenous Media Networks in South Asia’s Decolonial Mediascapes.” Global Asia Conference, UC Irvine.
- 2026 | “Process Over Policing: Algorithmic Ecologies and the Pedagogy of Critical Making.” Roundtable contribution, panel on Addressing AI in the Classroom: Perils and Opportunities. USC Future of Writing Symposium, University of Southern California.
- 2025 | “Naachi Se Baanchi: Decolonial Cinema and Indigenous Visual Sovereignty in Contemporary India.” 28th European Conference on South Asian Studies.
- 2025 | “Screening the Adivasis (Indigenous): Disassembling Visions and Voices of Indigenous Media Production in India.” Visible Evidence XXXI, Philadelphia.
- 2024 | Discussant. “Merging Horizons: Visual Anthropology, Indigenous Communities, and the Work of Online Media Archives.” Royal Anthropological Institute, London.
- 2022 | “Reimagining Gaze: Politics of Community Media and Film Making in India.” Arts in Society Conference, Zaragoza, Spain.
- 2020 | Panel Chair. Making the Subject: Interdisciplinary Explorations. School of Human Studies, Ambedkar University Delhi.
- 2018 | “Remembering through Film (Making).” The Image Conference, Hong Kong.
- 2018 | “On Becoming Ho: Not (just) a Film.” Deleuze India Conference, Chennai.
- 2016 | “Hum, Tum, and Transformation.” Transformative Rural Development Conference, India International Centre, New Delhi.

Film, Archive, and Multimodal Production

Curator and Metadata Architect, *Ways of Seeing* — 2021–present.

Digital archive of Indigenous media on Omeka and WordPress; custom metadata schema encoding community access and consent conditions at the field level.

Counter-Mapping Layer, *Ways of Seeing* — in development.

Public digital output of the dissertation, pairing community spatial records with administrative land classification of the same sites.

Director and Editor, *Ayangraji* — 2021.

Director, Producer, and Editor, *Envisioning Development Practice* — 2019.

Centre for Development Practice, Ambedkar University Delhi.

Director and Producer, *Chinhari: The Young India* — 2019.

Producer, *Inoculating Lac* — 2019.

Director and Producer, *Collaborating on Lac* — 2018.

Curator, film program, website, and YouTube channel — 2018–2019.

Centre for Development Practice, Ambedkar University Delhi. Ethnographic film curation focused on the Jharkhand, Odisha, and Chhattisgarh belt.

Teaching Experience

Sole instructor

Curriculum design, lead instruction, and grading. UCLA appointment title: Associate Instructor; Instructor of Record for summer courses.

Critical Media Literacy, UCLA — Spring 2025, Spring 2026.

Undergraduate writing seminar on platform capitalism, algorithmic bias, and generative-AI literacy, including a student prompt-log audit of large language models for data bias and representational gaps.

Video Skills and Techniques, UCLA — Summer 2025, Summer 2026, 2022–2023.

Rural Through Art, Literature, and Film, Ambedkar University Delhi — Fall 2020.

Taught remotely; recorded lectures, LMS modules, and asynchronous discussion alongside live sessions.

Teaching assistant

Data Justice and Society, UCLA — 2024–2026.

Interdisciplinary cluster; four terms on data colonialism and algorithmic governance.

Taught by: Profs. Miriam Posner and Juliet Williams.

Documenting Culture, UCLA — Fall 2023.

Taught by: Prof. Aparna Sharma.

Field Research Methods, UCLA — Winter 2023.

Taught by: Prof. Alex Flynn.

Ashoka University — 2017–2021.

Courses: Politics of Development; Political Ideologies; Anthropology of Work: Work and Labour; Social and Political Formations; Introduction to Indian Politics; Comparative Politics; Great Books (2018).

Taught by: Profs. Vinay Sitapati, Sandipto Dasgupta, Deepak Mehta, Bann Seng Tan, and Aparna Vaidik.

Taught fully online, 2020–2021: Comparative Politics (Summer 2020, Prof. Bann Seng Tan); Politics of Development (Monsoon 2020); Anthropology of Work: Work and Labour (Monsoon 2020, Prof. Deepak Mehta); Indian Politics / The BJP before Modi (Spring 2021, Prof. Vinay Sitapati). Recorded lectures, LMS modules, and asynchronous discussion alongside live Zoom sessions and conferences.

Course evaluations by section: Indian Politics / The BJP before Modi (Spring 2021), 5.00, 5.00, 5.00, 5.00, and 4.96 of 5 across five sections, 56 respondents; Comparative Politics (Summer 2020), 4.44, 4.82, and 4.65 of 5 across three sections, 26 respondents.

Pedagogical Consulting

Humanities Technology Consultant, UCLA Humanities Division — 2026–2027.

Primary point of contact for instructional technology solutions and support for Humanities faculty and graduate students.

Lead consultant training sessions and deliver workshops for faculty and teaching assistants on instructional technology and digital humanities tools.

Support administration of faculty and graduate-student-led digital humanities projects; contribute to Digital Humanities course instruction.

Teaching Assistant Consultant, UCLA Teaching and Learning Center and Undergraduate Education Initiatives — 2026–2027.

Instructor for 495M and 495N, writing pedagogy courses for teaching assistants. Training, supervision, and curriculum-design support.

Teaching Assistant Consultant, UCLA Graduate Division — 2025–2026.

Instructor for two graduate pedagogy seminars, 495 and 496; 496 taught remotely.

Design and instruction: Graduate Teaching Assistant Seminar on inclusive grading, curriculum design, and classroom management, including process-based writing assessment as an alternative to algorithmic AI detection.

Workshop topics: bias in AI detectors against multilingual writers; affective barriers to technical fluency; and metacognitive scaffolding as the skill generative systems cannot substitute for.

Related Work Experience

Graduate Student Researcher, UCLA — 2021–2026.

Supervisors: Profs. Dan Froot (Winter–Fall 2024); David Shorter (Winter and Spring 2023); Anurima Banerji (2021–2026).

Project Researcher and Curator, Centre for Development Practice — 2018–2021.

Ford Foundation and Ambedkar University Delhi. Multi-year project on culturally sensitive filmmaking and media documentation in the Indigenous belt of eastern India; film projects and website content for the Ways of Seeing archive (2019–2021).

Research Assistant, UCLA — 2019.

Assisted Prof. Sandipto Dasgupta on *Legalizing the Revolution* (Cambridge University Press India, 2021): archival research and data synthesis on constitutional history and Indigenous rights.

Research Consultant, Centre for Development Practice — February–May 2019.

Project Executive, PRADAN, Jharkhand — May–July 2018.

Transcription Consultant, CORD India — December 2016–January 2017.

Centre of Research and Dissemination, under Dr. Meera Samson.

Research Assistant, Centre for Community Knowledge — March 2015.

Ambedkar University Delhi. Post-Partition oral history project on Nizamuddin, Delhi, with Vani Subramanian, Independent Director.

Rapporteur, Philosophy of Education Conference — January 2015.

Azim Premji University, Bangalore.

Advocacy Coordinator, Society for Labour and Development — 2014–2015.

Delhi. Under Ananya Bhattacharjee, Director.

Program Monitor, Kaivalya Education Foundation — July–October 2014.

Field Translator, SOAS, University of London — April 2014.

Under Dr. Satoshi Miyamura; fieldwork on shifting time patterns in trade unions and industrial relocation in Delhi, Haryana, and Himachal Pradesh, and in Mirpur, Bangladesh.

Research Associate, ICSSR project on migration and industrial work — 2013–2014.

With Prof. Sumangala Damodaran, Ambedkar University Delhi.

Leadership and Service

- Chair, Communications Board, Associated Students UCLA (ASUCLA) (2025–present); Vice-Chair (2024–2025); Member (2022–2023).
- Chair and Lead Organizer, Graduate Student Conference on South Asia, Center for India and South Asia (CISA), UCLA (2025–2026).
- Graduate Member, Graduate Leadership Academy, UCLA (2026).
- Editorial Board Member, *Comitatus: A Journal of Medieval and Renaissance Studies*, vols. 54 and 55, CMRS Center for Early Global Studies, UCLA (2023–2024).
- Graduate Liaison, Faculty Search Committee, Department of World Arts and Cultures/Dance, UCLA (2022–2023).
- Member, Professional Development Committee, Department of World Arts and Cultures/Dance, UCLA (2021–2023).
- Member, Chew on This Graduate Students' Presentation Series Committee, Department of World Arts and Cultures/Dance, UCLA (2021–2023).
- Member, Graduate Student Organization, Department of World Arts and Cultures/Dance, UCLA (2021–present).
- Student Faculty Coordinator, M.Phil., School of Human Studies, Ambedkar University Delhi (2015–2017).
- Student Faculty Coordinator, M.A., School of Development Studies, Ambedkar University Delhi (2013–2014).
- Convener and Founding Member, Departmental Placement Cell, School of Development Studies, Ambedkar University Delhi (2013–2014).
- Vice President, Dramatics Society, Sri Venkateswara College (2011–2012).

Language Proficiency

- English: native/bilingual proficiency.
- Hindi: native/bilingual proficiency.
- Punjabi: conversational proficiency.
- Sadri/Nagpuri: advanced field research proficiency.
- Ho: field research proficiency.
- Mundari/Kudukh: working proficiency, for analyzing media texts.

Professional Memberships

- Association for Asian Studies; AAS.
- American Anthropological Association AAA.
- Society for Cinema and Media Studies; SCMS
- European Conference on South Asian Studies, ECSAS
- European Association of Social Anthropologists; EASA
- Center for India and South Asia; CISA
- American Association of Geographers; AAG